Project Plan: "Better" Modular Foundation (18 months)

Four phases build the integration and data foundation first, then unify customer channels, then scale and prepare for the "Best" core replacement

1. Mobilize & Design
Months 0–3

Milestone 1: Lock Target Architecture & Business Case
Confirm scope, API/data blueprint, KPIs and budget

Dependencies: Executive sponsorship (CIO, CFO); complete system inventory

Milestone 2: Stand Up Transformation Office
Set up PMO and product squads; select integration, cloud data and CRM vendors

Dependencies: Procurement lead times; skills gaps may need partners

Milestone 3: Stabilize CoreBank Batch Jobs
Add monitoring and fix the daily P1 batch failures as a quick win

Dependencies: CoreBank vendor support; change-freeze windows

Outputs: Approved blueprint and roadmap; teams and vendors in place; fewer P1 incidents

2. Build Integration & Data Foundation
Months 3–9

Milestone 1: Launch API & Integration Layer
API gateway and event bus around CoreBank; replace priority point-to-point links

Dependencies: CoreBank interface documentation; security review

Milestone 2: Deploy Cloud Data Lakehouse
Ingest core, CRM and channel data; set data ownership and quality rules

Dependencies: Cloud landing zone; regulatory data-residency approval

Milestone 3: Go Live with Automated Reporting
Move priority regulatory and management reports and BI dashboards off SmartReports

Dependencies: One parallel run against old reports; compliance sign-off

Outputs: Reusable APIs; single source of truth for data; trusted near-real-time reporting

3. Unify Customer Engagement
Months 9–14

Milestone 1: Launch New CRM Platform
Merge FinCRM and EmailBanker into one cloud CRM with a 360° customer view

Dependencies: Clean customer data in the lakehouse; marketing training and adoption

Milestone 2: Release Omnichannel App & Portal
Rebuild MobileSmartApp and OnlineBank on shared APIs; fix session logouts

Dependencies: API layer live; UX research; app-store release cycle

Milestone 3: Enable Digital Onboarding & e-Sign
Launch eKYC onboarding integrated with eSignAuth

Dependencies: KYC/AML regulatory approval; identity-verification vendor

Outputs: Single customer view; higher CX and NPS; more self-service, less branch load

4. Scale, Optimize & Prepare for "Best"
Months 14–18

Milestone 1: Decommission Legacy Integrations
Retire point-to-point links and SmartReports

Dependencies: All consumers migrated; tested rollback plan

Milestone 2: Embed DevOps & Product Model
CI/CD, FinOps cost tracking and KPI reviews across product teams

Dependencies: Team upskilling; role and HR changes

Milestone 3: Approve Core Modernization Roadmap
Business case and vendor shortlist for a cloud-native core

Dependencies: Phase 1–3 KPI results; board approval

Outputs: Lower run cost; faster releases; low-risk path to the core replacement

Source: SmartBank "Better" scenario (modular foundation), prioritized pain points, systems overview and strategic objectives